

## *MONEY IN THE BANK*

**M**Y FIRST DECISION ABOUT MY STAKE WAS TO PUT IT SOME-  
place where it would gain simple interest while I looked  
for better ways to invest it. But these days, simple in-  
terest is no longer so simple. First you have to choose  
the best bank, or savings-and-loan, or money-market fund, or  
other competing depository.

In my neighborhood in Miami Beach, Florida, there were two  
or three banks and/or savings-and-loans to the block. Along one  
side of one street where I walked, the personal computer store,  
the drugstore/luncheonette, a hairdresser, and an optometrist all  
had been replaced by various financial services. In this short stretch  
of shops, there was a new Savings of America, a Southeast Bank,  
a First Nationwide Savings, and a Glendale Federal, plus Dis-Com  
Securities, a discount stockbroker that offered a money-market  
alternative to the banks.

In the two blocks that followed, there was a Chase Federal,  
Safra Bank, Citicorp Savings, Carteret Savings, Lincoln Savings  
and Loan, American Savings and Loan, Centrust Savings and Loan,  
the Jefferson National Bank, as well as a Prudential-Bache, a  
Merrill Lynch, a Drexel Burnham Lambert, and Chicago Com-  
modity Corporation. Down the road was a Sun Bank.

If the few remaining clothing stores, delis, beauty salons, and  
restaurants go out of business and this banking trend continues,  
soon there will be nothing to shop for except interest rates, and  
we'll be cashing checks and making deposits up and down both  
sides of the street, 24 hours a day. If the country as a whole moves  
any further in the same direction, we'll quickly become a nation  
of brokers and tellers.